

Docs in
Proton Drive



Proton Docs

How does the world's most secure word processor fare in real life?

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With the increasing demand for customisable privacy and security features, thanks to the debates sparking around data privacy and protection all across the globe, Proton, the famous VPN brand, has launched its own word processor that promises complete security of users' information every step of the way. When it launched, there was quite a buzz around the Digit Test Centre, as Proton Docs comes with end-to-end encryption, which extends to every mouse movement on the page!

What are its features?

Proton Docs has most of the features that you would expect from a word processor. So will not dive deep into that here. However, the way Proton Docs stands out is, by integrating privacy features that we have rarely seen in a mainstream product. As mentioned in a release article published by Anant Vijay, the Product Lead for Proton Drive and Mail, "...even keystrokes and cursor movements are encrypted." This claim grabbed

our eyeballs. Now, there is no solid way for us to test this, but the fact that all of the privacy features are open for audit by independent entities, thanks to the fact that it has open-source end-to-end encryption. Another major feature that was pointed out in the release documentation was that the data servers for Proton Docs are based in Switzerland, governed by the country's neutral yet strict privacy laws. As stated in the documentation published on Proton's own page, and what I could find in my research, Switzerland makes for a great place for a data server. This is thanks to its political neutrality and the fact it is outside of US and EU jurisdiction.

What this means is that the country is mostly never under the pressure of any overarching institution to share the data stored in its servers. Sure, there are workarounds, but we will leave that for the lawmakers to debate on. Couple this sense of political security and the laws that are in place regarding data privacy and security, and you have for yourself, a data safe haven.

Google Docs vs Proton Mail – How does it compare?

One of the first things that would come to your mind, having read so far -- Why should I switch from Google Docs? What will I get in terms of features?

Well, I had the same question and put it to test. Proton Docs misses out on some quality of life features which mostly have to do with the formatting options that are available to you. I know that there are tons of more formatting that we can talk about, however, the ones selected by me were some of the most looked out for by the Digit Team. Another thing that I noticed while writing this article on Proton Docs was the limitation of the different dialects of English. Proton Docs for me, defaulted to English UK, which is a plus for me. However, without an in-built dictionary, this might be an issue for the people who use other dialects of the language. I could not see any option to change the dialect that was being used. In terms of sharing documents, the process is as seamless as you would get in Google Docs or any other web based word processor.

Should you switch?

Well, in my opinion, if you are someone who is working with sensitive information, for example, as a journalist, legal professional, or artist, then you definitely should switch to Proton Docs. It comes pretty close to Google Docs in almost all respects, and in terms of privacy trumps it.

The generative AI boom has brought data protection and privacy debate to the forefront, and there could not be a better time for Proton to launch their word processor. Proton acted on the word of the community, and has delivered a product that would be cherished by many and hated by few. And, given the fact that you can get access to its mailing service, drive storage, practically their entire product suite for free, Proton Docs is a must try. **digit**

